News digest

In Asia, Powell defends N. Korea policy

SEOUL -- Secretary of State Colin L. Powell yesterday sought to fend off complaints from key partners in the effort to end North Korea's nuclear programs that the Bush administration has not been sufficiently creative or willing to compromise in the negotiations.

Japan to Deport Ex-Chess Champion Bobby Fischer (Reuters)

Reuters - Japan issued a deportation order on Tuesday against former world chess champion Bobby Fischer, who is wanted in the United States for defying sanctions on Yugoslavia, an immigration official said.

Democrat Seeks to End Iowa, N.H. Power (AP)

AP - If Simon Rosenberg decides to run for Democratic Party chairman, he won't be able to count on much support from Iowa and New Hampshire.

Hague Court Imposes Defense Counsel on Milosevic

THE HAGUE (Reuters) - Judges at The Hague tribunal on Thursday imposed a defense counsel on former Yugoslav President Slobodan Milosevic to avoid further delays in his war crimes trial.

Senate Panel Gives NASA Extra Money (AP)

AP - NASA would get 16.4 billion next year under a bill a Senate committee approved Tuesday, reversing a decision by House lawmakers to cut the space agency's budget below this year's levels.

Sharon acknowledges ignoring road map

Prime Minister Ariel Sharon acknowledged that Israel was not following the moribund Mideast peace plan, and said an Israeli pullout from the Gaza Strip was unlikely to revive it, according